

The *state* of a program is the set of values of all the variables at a given moment. *Saving state* refers to saving these values so they can be recovered if the program crashes or the user closes it.

A common way to save a program's state is to write the current values to a JSON file. *JSON (JavaScript Object Notation)* is a way of storing data that's easy for programs to read back. Originally developed for use in JavaScript programs, JSON is now used by many programming languages.

The JSON format can be read by programs and by humans. Some simple JSON data files look just like Python code. Python has libraries you can use to simplify reading and writing JSON files.